

Emergency Procedures

100% Cleaner Los Angeles, California

Purpose: This document provides step-by-step procedures for common emergencies encountered during residential cleaning operations. Every team member must read, understand, and follow these protocols. When in doubt, **prioritize safety, notify the office immediately, and document everything.**

Emergency Office Line: _____ **Owner / Manager Cell:** _____ **After-Hours Line:** _____

General Emergency Principles

1. **Safety first** — protect people, then property
 2. **Stop work** if the situation is unsafe
 3. **Call the office immediately** — do not wait until the job is finished
 4. **Document** with photos and a written incident report within 24 hours
 5. **Never admit legal fault** to clients — be empathetic, not defensive
 6. **Never leave a client home unsecured** (unlocked doors, missing keys)
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Quick Reference Card

Emergency	First Action	Call Office?	Call 911?
Breakage / Damage	Stop, photo, secure item	Yes — immediately	No
Injury (any)	First aid, ensure safety	Yes — immediately	If serious
Lockout	Call office, wait for instruction	Yes — immediately	No
Client Complaint	Listen, don't argue, document	Yes — before leaving	No
Severe Weather	Assess safety, may cancel	Yes	If emergency
Chemical Spill	Ventilate, contain, evacuate if needed	Yes	If toxic exposure

Fire / Gas Leak	Evacuate immediately	Yes, when safe	YES — 911
Break-In / Suspicious Activity	Do not enter, call office	Yes — immediately	If active threat
Client Medical Emergency	Call 911, then office	Yes	YES — 911

1. Breakage & Property Damage

Accidents happen. How you respond determines whether a minor incident becomes a major problem.

Immediate Steps (First 5 Minutes)

1. **STOP** cleaning in the affected area
2. **Ensure safety** — broken glass, spilled liquid, sharp edges
3. **Do NOT throw away** broken items — client may want to assess
4. **Photograph** the damage, the item, and surrounding area (multiple angles)
5. **Call the office immediately:** _____
6. **Do NOT** offer to pay cash, buy a replacement, or promise compensation — the office handles all resolution

If the Client Is Home

1. Locate the client calmly and respectfully
2. Say: *"I need to let you know something happened during cleaning. I want to be upfront with you right away."*
3. Show them the damage honestly
4. Express genuine concern: *"I'm very sorry this happened. I've already contacted my manager, and we'll take care of this."*
5. **Do not admit negligence or legal fault** — be empathetic without assigning blame
6. Provide the office phone number if the client wants to speak with management directly

If the Client Is Not Home

1. Call the office **before leaving the property**
2. Leave a professional note (if instructed by office):
 - *"Hi [Name], during today's clean, an accident occurred. I've documented it and our manager will contact you today. — 100% Cleaner"*

3. Complete the Incident Report Form
4. Do not leave without ensuring the home is secure (locked, alarm set)

Documentation Required

Complete within **24 hours**:

- ☐ Incident Report Form (date, time, location, description)
- ☐ Photos of damage and item
- ☐ Photos of surrounding area (context)
- ☐ List of what was being cleaned when it occurred
- ☐ Witness names (if another cleaner was present)
- ☐ Client communication log

Common Damage Scenarios

Scenario	Response
Broken glass / ceramic	Sweep carefully, photo all pieces, bag debris, do not discard
Scratched surface	Photo at multiple angles, note cleaning product and method used
Stained fabric / carpet	Do NOT attempt further cleaning — blot only, photo, report
Damaged electronics	Unplug if safe, do not touch further, photo, report
Wall damage (scuff, chip)	Photo, note what caused it, report

Insurance

Company general liability insurance may cover qualifying claims. The office will file claims — cleaners do not contact the insurance company directly.

2. Injury & Medical Emergencies

Cleaner Injury

Minor injury (cut, scrape, sprain):

1. Administer first aid from the company first aid kit
2. Stop working if the injury affects your ability to clean safely
3. Call the office to report

4. Complete an Incident Report Form
5. Seek medical attention if needed — do not minimize injuries

Serious injury (deep cut, fall, chemical exposure, chest pain, heat exhaustion):

1. **Call 911 first**
2. Ensure the area is safe for others
3. Call the office as soon as safely possible
4. Do not drive yourself if seriously injured
5. Workers' comp (W-2 employees): report same day for coverage eligibility

Client Injury

If a client is injured during your visit (slip on wet floor, trip over equipment):

1. **Call 911** if the injury appears serious
2. Render reasonable assistance (do not move an injured person unless in immediate danger)
3. Place warning signs near wet floors
4. Call the office immediately
5. Do not make statements about fault
6. Document with photos and written report

Heat Exhaustion (Common in LA)

Los Angeles summer temperatures create real risk.

Prevention:

- Bring water; drink regularly
- Take breaks in shaded or air-conditioned areas
- Watch for dizziness, nausea, excessive sweating, confusion

Response:

1. Move to a cool area immediately
2. Drink water slowly
3. Call the office — you may need to stop the job
4. Call 911 if symptoms are severe (confusion, fainting, no sweating)

3. Lockout Procedures

A lockout occurs when you cannot access the client's home at the scheduled time.

Causes

- Client forgot to leave key / code doesn't work
- Lockbox empty or code changed
- Smart lock battery dead
- Gate code incorrect
- Client not home and no access method available

Steps

1. **Arrive on time** and attempt all documented access methods
2. **Wait 15 minutes** — attempt to contact the client via office (never use personal contact info unless approved)
3. **Call the office:** _____
4. **Document** your arrival time, attempts made, and photos of the door/lockbox
5. **Do NOT** force entry, climb fences, or enter through unlocked windows
6. **Do NOT** leave and come back without office approval

Office Will:

- Contact the client
- Reschedule if access cannot be obtained
- Apply lockout fee per service agreement (\$_____ or deposit forfeiture)

If Client Arrives Late

- Begin service if time allows within the scheduled window
- If the window has passed, call the office for guidance
- Do not start a full clean if insufficient time remains without office approval

4. Client Complaint Handling

Client complaints may arise during the visit, at completion, or after you leave. Handle every complaint with professionalism.

During the Visit (Client Is Home)

1. **Listen fully** — do not interrupt or get defensive

2. **Acknowledge:** *"I understand, and I want to make this right."*
3. **Ask specifics:** *"Can you show me exactly what you're concerned about?"*
4. **Fix what you can immediately** if it is within scope and time allows
5. **Call the office** if the complaint cannot be resolved on the spot
6. **Never argue**, raise your voice, or blame the client

Common Complaints & Responses

Complaint	Response
"You missed the baseboards"	"Let me take care of that right now." (If deep clean scope)
"This wasn't cleaned last time"	"I'm sorry to hear that. Let me address it today and I'll have my manager follow up."
"You're taking too long"	Call office for guidance; do not rush and cut quality
"I don't want you back"	"I'm sorry we didn't meet your expectations. I'll let my manager know." Call office before leaving.
"Something is broken"	Follow Breakage Procedure (Section 1)
"Your cleaner was rude"	Listen, apologize for their experience, call office immediately

After-Visit Complaints

All after-visit complaints are handled by the office. If a client contacts you directly:

1. Be polite and empathetic
2. Direct them to the office: _____
3. **Do not** offer free cleans, refunds, or compensation on your own
4. Notify the office that the client contacted you

Escalation Triggers (Call Office Immediately)

- Client threatens legal action
- Client refuses to pay
- Client uses abusive or threatening language
- Client appears intoxicated or aggressive
- Any safety concern

If you feel unsafe: Leave the property, call the office, and call 911 if necessary.

5. Severe Weather Procedures

Los Angeles weather events include heavy rain, extreme heat, Santa Ana winds, wildfire smoke, and occasional flooding.

Before the Job

- Check weather alerts each morning
- Office may cancel or reschedule proactively — wait for confirmation before assuming a cancel

Heavy Rain & Flooding

- Drive carefully; allow extra travel time
- Do not enter homes with active flooding or roof leaks affecting electrical areas
- Place mats at entry points to prevent tracking water
- Cancel if roads in the client's area are closed or unsafe

Extreme Heat (100°F+)

- See Heat Exhaustion guidance in Section 2
- Schedule outdoor tasks (exterior windows, patio) for cooler hours if possible
- Office may reschedule afternoon jobs in extreme heat advisories

Wildfire Smoke & Air Quality

- Monitor AQI (Air Quality Index) at airnow.gov
- If AQI exceeds 150 (unhealthy), limit strenuous activity
- If AQI exceeds 200 (very unhealthy), office should cancel outdoor-adjacent work
- Keep windows closed if client requests; use air filtration if available
- If evacuation orders affect the service area, **do not attempt the job**

Earthquake (During a Job)

1. **Drop, Cover, Hold On** — get under a sturdy table or desk
2. Stay away from windows, mirrors, and heavy objects
3. After shaking stops, assess for gas leaks, structural damage, or injuries
4. Evacuate if the building appears unsafe
5. Call the office when safe
6. Do not re-enter until building is confirmed safe

Office Cancellation Protocol

The office will notify affected clients and cleaners by _____ (text/app). Cleaners: **do not self-cancel** without office approval unless you are in immediate danger.

6. Chemical Spill & Exposure Procedures

Cleaning chemicals are safe when used correctly. Emergencies occur when products are mixed improperly, spilled in concentrated form, or used in unventilated spaces.

Prevention (Always)

- **NEVER mix bleach with ammonia, vinegar, or any other product**
- Read SDS sheets for all products
- Use gloves and eye protection
- Ensure ventilation (open windows, run exhaust fans)
- Store chemicals upright in caddies; secure lids during transport

Minor Spill (Small amount, known product, no symptoms)

1. Ventilate the area — open windows and doors
2. Wear gloves; use paper towels to contain spill
3. Dispose of cleanup materials in client's trash (sealed in bag)
4. Wipe area with water
5. Report to office at end of job

Major Spill or Mixed Chemical Reaction (Fumes, hissing, discoloration)

1. **Evacuate the area immediately** — get yourself and anyone else out of the room/home
2. **Call the office:** _____
3. If anyone has difficulty breathing, dizziness, burning eyes, or nausea: **Call 911**
4. **Do NOT** attempt to neutralize or clean up unknown chemical reactions
5. Wait for office instruction before re-entering
6. If fumes are strong, notify the client (if present) to evacuate and call 911

Chemical Exposure to Skin or Eyes

Exposure	Response
Skin contact	Rinse with water for 15+ minutes. Remove contaminated clothing.

Eye contact	Rinse eyes with water for 15+ minutes. Hold eyelids open. Call 911 if burning persists.
Inhalation	Move to fresh air immediately. Call 911 if breathing difficulty.
Ingestion	Call Poison Control: 1-800-222-1222 . Call 911. Do not induce vomiting unless instructed.

Poison Control

National Poison Control: 1-800-222-1222 (save in your phone)

7. Additional Emergency Scenarios

Fire

1. **Evacuate immediately** — do not attempt to fight the fire unless it is tiny and you have an extinguisher
2. **Call 911**
3. Call the office when safe
4. Do not re-enter the building

Gas Leak (Rotten egg smell)

1. Do not flip light switches or create sparks
2. Evacuate the home immediately
3. Call 911 from outside
4. Call the office

Power Outage

- Continue non-electrical tasks if safe and adequate light exists
- Do not use client candles unless approved
- Report to office; client may need to reschedule tasks requiring vacuum/equipment

Lost or Stolen Keys

1. Call the office **immediately** — this is a security emergency
2. Do not leave until the office confirms next steps
3. Complete an Incident Report Form

4. Client will need to rekey or change codes — company policy on key replacement fees":

Suspicious Activity / Break-In Signs

If you arrive and see signs of break-in (broken window, open door, ransacked rooms):

1. **Do NOT enter**
2. Call 911 from a safe location
3. Call the office
4. Wait for police before entering

Pet Bite or Aggressive Animal

1. Remove yourself from the area safely
 2. Administer first aid for bites — wash with soap and water
 3. Call the office
 4. Seek medical attention — animal bites require professional evaluation
 5. Document the incident; office will contact client
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Incident Report Form

Complete for every emergency, injury, damage, or complaint event.

Field	Details
Date	
Time	
Cleaner Name(s)	
Client Name	
Service Address	
Job Type	☐ Regular (\$150) ☐ Deep (\$300) ☐ Other
Emergency Type	☐ Damage ☐ Injury ☐ Lockout ☐ Complaint ☐ Weather ☐ Chemical [] Other
Description of Event	
Immediate Actions Taken	

Office Notified?	☐ Yes — Time: _____ ☐ No
911 / Poison Control Called?	☐ Yes ☐ No
Photos Taken?	☐ Yes ☐ No
Client Present?	☐ Yes ☐ No
Client Response	
Witnesses	
Follow-Up Required	
Report Completed By	
Manager Review	Name: _____ Date: _____

Training & Compliance

- All new hires review this document during onboarding and sign acknowledgment
- Quarterly refresher review recommended
- Post the **Quick Reference Card** in company storage / team group chat
- Maintain a first aid kit in every company vehicle and storage location
- Maintain SDS binder (physical or digital) for all products used

100% Cleaner — Los Angeles, CA Template © The Cleaning CEO Blueprint. Customize emergency contacts before distributing to your team.